



Security Watch

Googkle.com

The Problem

In April, a warning was issued by Finnish anti-virus vendor F-Secure Corp. about a problematic site, googkle.com. One can reach this site by misspelling 'google.com'—and typing in 'googkle.com'—in the title bar of a Web browser.

The Damages

When googkle.com is opened in a browser, two pop-up windows are immediately launched, with redirects to third-party sites loaded with scripts. One of the sites, ntsearch.com, downloads and runs a 'pop.chm' file, and the other, toolbarpartner.com, downloads and runs a 'ddfs.chm' file, F-Secure said. "Both files are downloaded using exploits and they contain exploits themselves to run embedded executable files. One of the Web pages of the 'toolbarpartner.com' website downloads a file named 'pic10.jpg' using an exploit. This JPG file is an executable that replaces Windows Media Player," the warning reads. Also launched are a steady stream of pop-up Web pages with different .exe files. One batch of exploits loads a malware package that includes two backdoors, two Trojan droppers, a proxy Trojan, a spying Trojan and a Trojan downloader.

Precautions

It's mostly users of IE that seem to be affected. Windows XP users who have installed SP2 are also safe. However, to be on the safe side, just don't misspell 'google'!

WELL DONE, DELL!

Dell Integrates Windows x64

Dell will factory-install Microsoft's Windows XP Professional x64 Edition and Windows Server 2003 x64 editions operating systems across Dell Precision workstation and PowerEdge server lines. It has also reinforced available professional services that support faster migration of the enhanced features available in the x64-bit operating systems.

"Dell hardware has been 64-bit ready since June 2004, and we have worked extensively with Intel, Microsoft and applications vendor partners to drive development of standards-based solutions," said Jeff Clarke, senior vice president, Product Group, Dell. "Dell is committed to helping customers migrate from costly, proprietary platforms to cost-effective, and standards-based environments."

This is the same strategy that has delivered Dell workstation customers up to 10 times the performance at a tenth of the cost."

Dell PowerEdge servers with integrated Windows Server 2003 x64 Editions will be available in June.

YAHOO! GOES VIDEO

Yahoo's Video Search Is Out Of The Beta Phase

Yahoo! Inc. has shifted its online video search tool out of its test phase, marking another step in the Internet powerhouse's plan to use other media to lure more visitors to its Web site. The Sunnyvale-based company created a separate search channel for online videos in December. The product had been running as a test till recently.

As part of the upgrade, Yahoo! is indexing more video from several new media sources, including MTV and The Discovery Channel. Yahoo! touts its search engine as the Internet's most comprehensive source for finding online video, although the company won't disclose the index's size.

The push into online video has been driven largely by the growing number of homes with high-speed Internet connections, said Bradley Horowitz, Yahoo's director of media and desktop search. The speedier connections make it easier to watch video online without the delays and choppy delivery commonly experienced on dial-up connections.

Video clips available at

HOT

Opera 8

The latest avatar of this browser doesn't disappoint. It has all the customisable features and tweaks to keep the advanced user happy, while the neat interface should suffice for all the needs of the basic user.

Netscape 8 Beta

Netscape 8, though in beta stage, comes with a very crisp and sharp-looking interface. This, however, doesn't translate into excellent features. It's based on Firefox, and yet is bulkier, and lacks features and customisation options.

NOT

video.search.yahoo.com include movie previews, excerpts from previously broadcast TV shows as well as original content. Yahoo! is counting on video search to give it an advantage over Google Inc. Google processes about 47 percent of online searches in the US, leaving Yahoo! a distant second with 21 percent of the market, according to Nielsen/NetRatings.

"We want to be the place to go whenever people are trying to find online video," Horowitz said.

Google is testing an online video guide that relies on an index of closed-caption text from previously aired TV programmes, and recently began to encourage visitors to submit personal videos so they can be indexed.



One Silly Question Mac's fourth OS was called Panther, fifth is Tiger, what should the sixth be?



I think 'Lion' is perfect.
Satish Mudaliar, Mumbai



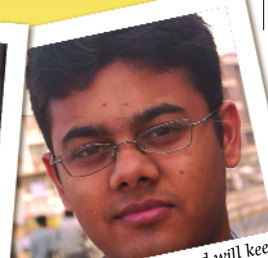
Maybe 'Monster'?
Gulshan Shetty, Mumbai



How about the 'Bear'?
Khyati Sanghvi, Gujarat



'Cheetah'-because it's the fastest!
Neel Parikh, Mumbai



'Leopard' sounds good and will keep it within the family!
Subhanshu Gupta, Navi Mumbai